The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY KEY NUMBERS FROM THE INBOX ON X CYCLE TRACKER EVENTS

KOSPI (THU, 2:35 P.M. KST)
5,371.18 −5.50%, with sell sidecars on both KOSPI and KOSDAQ; foreigners net sold ₩2.83 trillion · SK hynix ₩1,260,000 (−9.74%); Samsung below ₩200,000 intraday · NewDaily, Yonhap

MICRON (WED CLOSE)
$795.23 −7.00%, lowest close since Jul 29; Sandisk $1,037.40 (−7.91%); SOX 10,268.65 (−3.13%) while the S&P 500 rose 1.58% · AskTraders, StockAnalysis, Yahoo Finance

LEAD STORY

MARKETS · POLICY · SUPPLY

Blue-Wave Sell-Off Hits Memory Stocks as Suppliers Say the Shortage Gets Worse

Seoul fell about 5.5% as investors priced slower US data-center building. On the same day, a module maker and a Korean broker both said 2027 supply is already spoken for.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:40 IST Thursday (UTC+2) · Korean prices at about 2:40 p.m. KST, before the close · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · THURSDAY IN ASIA, WEDNESDAY IN NEW YORK

ASIA, THURSDAY (KOREA ~14:38 KST)

KOSPI	**5,377.56 (−5.39%)**
Samsung	**−7.68%**
SK hynix	**−9.31%**
KOSPI, Wed close	**5,683.80 (+0.62%)**
Kioxia	**below ¥10,000, 4th fall**
USD/KRW	**~1,341.7**

US WEDNESDAY CLOSES AND PRICES

Micron	**$795.23 (−7.00%)**
Sandisk	**$1,037.40 (−7.91%)**
SOX	**10,268.65 (−3.13%)**
DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.67 (−1.09%)**
DDR4 16Gb spot	**$81.68 (−0.30%)**
512Gb TLC wafer spot	**$16.15 (−4.33%)**

What this shows: suppliers describe a worsening shortage while the stocks and the spot market weaken. Korean figures are intraday (Yonhap, 14:38 KST). Correction to No. 29: Wednesday's Seoul close was KOSPI +0.62%, Samsung ₩218,000 (−0.68%), SK hynix ₩1,396,000 (−0.14%), not the 2 p.m. figures we printed (Yonhap, Newsis). Spot as of Nov 5, 11:00 Taipei time; wafer price weekly (TrendForce). Sources: Yonhap, NewDaily, Chosun Ilbo, Kabutan, AskTraders, StockAnalysis, Yahoo Finance, TrendForce, Reuters via Economic Times.

The US midterm results kept hitting AI hardware. On Wednesday the Dow rose 3.03% and the S&P 500 1.58%, but semiconductors fell. The SOX lost 3.13% to a six-month low, Micron 7.00%, Sandisk 7.91% and Nvidia 3.17%. (Yahoo Finance, Investing.com, Chosun Ilbo). In Seoul on Thursday, the KOSPI opened 1.82% lower and a sell sidecar was triggered at 10:16. Another followed on the KOSDAQ at 14:27. By 14:38 the KOSPI was down 5.39%, SK hynix 9.31% and Samsung 7.68%; Samsung Electro-Mechanics was down nearly 15% (Yonhap, NewDaily). In Tokyo, Kioxia fell for a fourth straight day, back below ¥10,000 (Kabutan).

Supply news pointed the other way. Team Group's chief executive, Chen Ching-wen, said the worst of the shortage runs from the fourth quarter through the end of the second quarter of 2027, with "no downward trend in price whatsoever", and that the market may not balance until the second half of 2028

or later (Tom's Hardware). Meritz Securities says customer orders for 2027–28 far exceed supply, and that a slower US build-out would not change that much (via X). Spot prices are slipping, though: DDR5 16Gb fell 1.09% and 512Gb TLC NAND wafers 4.33% in a week (TrendForce).

Our call: unchanged overall; DRAM steady as spot edges lower, NAND a touch looser; policy risk rising.

CYCLE SIGNAL: SUPPLY TIGHT, STOCKS PRICING SLOWER DEMAND

DEMAND · PHONES · DATA CENTER

Qualcomm Says Memory Costs Are Shrinking the Phone Business

Qualcomm's fiscal fourth-quarter revenue was $10.44 billion and adjusted EPS $2.17. Handset revenue fell 26% to $5.14 billion "as rising memory costs force handset makers to raise prices". Qualcomm expects the handset market to be flat in 2027, and guided next-quarter EPS to $2.15–2.35, against about $2.27 expected. The shares fell about 7% after hours. Data-center revenue was $650 million, toward a $5 billion target for fiscal 2027; chief executive Cristiano Amon said, "We don't have a demand issue; it's a supply issue" (CNBC). Like AMD in PCs, this is high memory prices cutting consumer device demand, which the playbook flags as a late-cycle signal.

SUPPLY · TAIWAN · MODULES

A Module Maker Warns That "Even Money Can't Buy Goods"

On its Nov 2 earnings call, Team Group said spot prices are 30–50% above contract and that the DDR5 16Gb contract price rose from $8.70 in October 2025 to $48 in September 2026. It said Chinese makers CXMT and YMTC are nearing a 10% share, and that business customers now make up 64.6% of its sales. The shortage could reach a point where "even money can't buy goods", Chen said, and will "get worse next year" (Tom's Hardware, BigGo Finance). Module makers buy at spot and contract, so this is a buyer's view of supply.

HBM · FOUNDRY · MATERIALS

Samsung Plans a Giheung Fab for HBM Base Dies; a Taiwan Fire Hits AI-Server Laminate

Samsung plans an advanced foundry fab, "Project Kairos", at its Giheung campus, at an estimated ₩25 trillion. It would make 2nm base dies for HBM5 and 4nm dies for HBM4/4E, with the building finished in late 2028 (Digitimes, Financial News, Seoul Economic Daily) REPORT. Samsung's second Taylor fab is reported fully booked for HBM base dies (TrendForce, via X). Early on Nov 4, a fire hit Panasonic's Hukou plant in Hsinchu, which makes MEGTRON laminate for AI-server boards: about 20% of MEGTRON capacity and about 4% of global high-end laminate. Output can move to Japan and China, and the industry sees limited immediate impact (Commercial Times, Economic Daily News).

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE NOV 4, 08:15 IST

NEW **Midterms and semis.** A Democratic Congress could mean more AI regulation and possibly slower AI spending; a broker's Washington team held a morning-after call on the risks. Jefferies semis daily; Washington strategy call (Nov 4)

NEW **Qualcomm, read by the brokers.** One rates it Neutral with a $165 target: data-center growth weighs on chip-segment margins while the smartphone market is soft. Another sees data center gaining momentum, with margin headwinds in the near term. Broker notes (QCOM FQ4)

NEW **AMD targets move up.** Two brokers raised AMD to $700 targets, with 2027 revenue around $94–101 billion. Another expects 2027 PC units down by double digits on memory costs. Broker notes (AMD Q3)

Equipment and optics. MKS rated Overweight ($600), GlobalFoundries Overweight ($80), Camtek Neutral ($125); a separate note argues optical names are near a low after meetings with Marvell and Lumentum. Intel's CEO bought about $9.7 million of stock (Form 4). Broker notes; SEC filing

ON X · SINCE WED ~08:00 · IST

@jukan05 · Nov 5 04:59
Meritz: customer orders for 2027–28 far exceed supply; a US data-center delay after the blue wave is unlikely to change the shortage much.
x.com/.../2118176254956544132

@pequityresearch · Nov 4 15:38
JPMorgan sees blended HBM ASP up 96% in 2027.
x.com/.../2117974696599707813

@pequityresearch · Nov 5 05:01
UNCONFIRMED Korean media: Sam Altman asked SK hynix and Samsung for specialty memory, including HBM, for 2027–2030, beyond what they can supply.
x.com/.../2118176886874337451

@pequityresearch · Nov 4 20:00
Nomura sees SK hynix DRAM ASP stable and elevated through end-2028.
x.com/.../2118040582350127583

CYCLE TRACKER · UNCHANGED: SUPPLY FIRM, SPOT SOFTER, POLICY RISK UP

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 4 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	Team Group: DDR5 16Gb contract $8.70 → $48 in a year, no downtrend yet; JPM HBM ASP +96% in 2027; Nomura SK hynix DRAM ASP elevated through 2028	**Rising, slower**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.67 (−1.09%) after a flat week; DDR4 16Gb −0.30%; 512Gb TLC wafer −4.33% on a weak Double 11; Team Group puts spot 30–50% above contract	**Edging lower**
LTAs / lead times	Meritz: 2027–28 orders far exceed supply; AMD purchase commitments $48.8B (via X); Samsung Taylor base-die line fully booked (report)	**Long, firm**
Margins / guide	Qualcomm handset −26% on memory costs, soft guide; AMD plans PC units down double digits in 2027; end-demand cracks in consumer devices	**Peak zone**
Capex / new supply	Samsung Giheung base-die fab (~₩25T, shell late 2028; report); CXMT/YMTC IPOs and capacity push; output lands 2028–30	**Building**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 29, NOV 4)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and booked into 2028. Unchanged overall. Supply signals firmed again: Team Group sees the worst shortage through mid-2027 and balance in 2H28 or later, Meritz says 2027–28 orders exceed supply, and JPMorgan and Nomura see HBM and DRAM prices staying high. But the edges loosened a little. DDR5 spot fell for the first time in a week, NAND wafer prices dropped 4.33%, and Qualcomm blamed memory costs for a 26% fall in handset revenue. Playbook: softer spot under rising contract, and consumer units hurt by prices, are both late-cycle signs. The stock sell-off (Micron −7%, SK hynix about −9%) is about US data-center timing, not memory pricing. Next tests: payrolls Friday, TSMC October sales on Nov 10, and Nvidia on Nov 17.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 5–18 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Thu Nov 5	Microchip, Lumentum, Nova after the close · Hon Hai and UMC October sales	Semis
Fri Nov 6	US October payrolls 15:30	Macro
Mon Nov 9	Sandisk split record date (8-for-1) · Nvidia AI Day Seoul	NAND
Tue Nov 10	TSMC October sales · US CPI 15:30 · CoreWeave (00:00 Nov 11)	AI
~Wed Nov 11	Korea Nov 1–10 exports (chips)	Trade

Thu Nov 12	Applied Materials (23:30) · Cisco · Nebius · Fri: Advantest, Shin-Etsu (per schedule)	WFE
Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3 results (call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 exhibits Nov 17–19	HBM

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